



```
<server name="
"
description="
"
network="
">
```

The next few lines contain information on the server administrator. If you are the administrator for the server, you must enter in the necessary details here. You'll also find space to enter operator information a little down in the configuration file. Operators are next in the hierarchy after administrators.

```
<admin name="
"
nick="
"
email="
">
```

The developers of Inspire IRCd have put in a line towards the end of the configuration to make sure that the user goes through the configuration file thoroughly.

Delete the line

```
<die value="No,
i wasnt joking. You
should probably edit
your config *PROPERLY*
and try again.">
```

We suggest that you go through the entire configuration to be sure of all the settings. We've only mentioned the necessary changes for the server to start. Once you are done with this step, close the Inspire IRCd window and restart the application. Click on the Start button and the server should turn on.

Connecting to the IRC server

Now that the IRC server is up and running, we'll show you to how to connect to it. If you run the server, you'll also have to join it to be able to chat with others. There are even more IRC clients than there are server applications. mIRC is the most popular one, but it's a commercial program. There are equally good free applications such

as HydraIRC (www.hydrairc.com) and XChat for Windows (<http://www.silverex.org/news/>). Firefox even has a plugin called Chatzilla (<https://addons.mozilla.org/en-US/firefox/addon/16/>) and Opera has had a built-in IRC client for sometime now. We find it better to use dedicated IRC clients rather than browsers for chatting. People tend to close their browsers every time they are done browsing and many people prefer to keep their IRC clients open through the day. For this reason, we want a light, dedicated IRC client, and so we'll use XChat.

Setting up XChat

Download and install XChat. Click on XChat > Network List. Enter a nickname and a backup nickname. The backup nickname will be used if someone is using your nick or if your connection timed out leaving your primary nick on the server.

Adding server connection details

Click on the Add button to add a new server to the list. Give a name for the network. Click on the Edit button. The field for servers has a default server setup. Click on the Edit button and enter the IP address or domain name of the IRC server. This should be the IP given by your ISP and not your local network IP. One of the simplest ways to find the right address is to visit a site such as www.whatismyip.com. If you are

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The server list on XChat

using the IRC service on the network, the PC name or the fixed IP address will both work as well.

Entering the channel name into XChat

Click on the Connect button to join the server. When you have connected to the server, XChat will throw up a window asking you to enter the channel you want to connect to. Enter the



Adding server connection details

relevant channel name. If you aren't prompted by your IRC client, you can join the channel by typing `/join #channelname`.

If you're travelling or are on a PC without an IRC client, then sites like Mibbit (www.mibbit.net) will let you connect to IRC servers. Simply enter a nickname, select the server address and connect to the channel you want to go to.

Getting on IRC from your mobile phone

Modern mobile phones running powerful operating systems can also run IRC clients. A few of them are available for every mobile platform. For Windows Mobile, the two known free ones are Pocket IRC (www.pocketirc.com) and zsIRC (www.zsirc.com). For the Symbian platform, there are applications such as mIRCGGI (<http://mirggi.net>). For those who use phones that only have a Java environment, there's jmIRC (<http://jmirc.sourceforge.net>). jmIRC runs on almost every handset with J2ME



jmIRC runs on almost every handset with J2ME

Connecting to IRC servers is done in a similar manner – the server address and port are entered. The channel is connected using the `/join` command once you are connected to the server. If there are problems connecting to the server, the command to do that is `/server irc.the_server_name.com`.

Start your instant messenger service

Google Talk is run on XMPP (Extensible Messaging and Presence Protocol) which is an open communication standard and protocol. It's actually pretty easy to create your own instant messaging network and we'll show you how. One of the great things about using your own instant messaging service is the flexibility to add or modify features as you wish.